

Palm Platform and applications

The Palm platform enjoys wide popularity. This has resulted in several software coming out, all of which offer similar features. People, as a result, are confused about which software to choose for a particular task. We've identified and categorised the most common tasks that you would use your Palm for, in order to help you choose the software most appropriate for each category.

Personal Information Managers

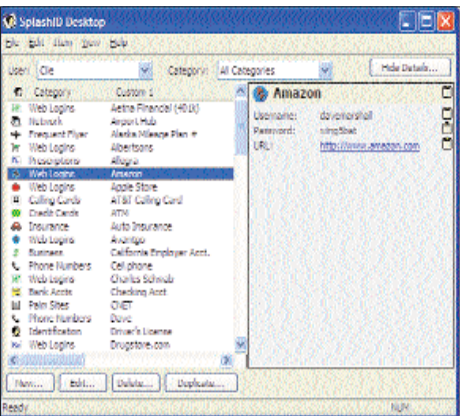
Personal Information Managers (PIMs) are programs that let you manage time and contact information—calendar, and task and address applications perform these functions. Although Palm handhelds come along with a Datebook, To-do and Address book, the functionality offered is minimal.

There are several replacement programs that add features to the basic Palm applications. Agendus is one such, which lets you manage information on your contacts. It offers a very comprehensive calendaring option for your tasks, and lets you read office e-mail and allows for linking To-dos with contact history. It also adds other features such as repeating and alarmed To-Dos, single-pane lookup of pending tasks, and much more.

DateBk5 is a program similar to Agendus. If you're looking for something more lightweight, consider HappyDays, a freeware application designed to help you remember dates of importance. Diddlebug is another freeware reminder program. Also worthy of mention is BugMe!, a reminder program with alarms.

Password Managers

These are programs that help you securely store passwords to Web sites, login details and other sensitive information, on your Palm handheld.



A companion desktop software for Windows and Macintosh lets you view, edit and synchronize sensitive personal information with your handheld

SplashID and SecureIt are two such programs. The security offered is good enough for ordinary use. SplashID supports high-resolution displays (320x320), and offers unlimited categories, colour and icon support. SecureIt is freeware.

Databases

A database is generally used as a repository for bulk information. One can store details about their video cassette library, MP3 song collection, etc. For example, you can download a huge and fairly comprehensive database on Hollywood movies collated from the movie Web site IMDB.com (Internet Movie Database) and impress your friends with movie trivia. Visit Memoware (www.memoware.com) for more on available databases; you will also find a healthy collection of free databases at the HandDBase Web site (<http://www.ddhsoftware.com/handbase.html>). Several programs help you create a database for the Palm. Of these, HandBase is a powerful solution that is fairly easy to learn with database templates. It comes with extensive documentation and offers data encryption.

Also available is MobileDB4; it is compatible with Microsoft Excel, Access and Filemaker, and brings along a Windows desktop companion.

A database can be used to store records of everything from birthdays, to the periodic table of elements

Office suites

Two major suites—Documents to Go and Quickoffice—let you type, edit and present documents on the Palm handheld. These offer applications for word processing, spreadsheets and office presentation. Both talk fairly well with Microsoft's Office suite for Windows; for example, a Word file can be viewed on a Palm handheld with bullets, headings and so on, intact. Moreover, hardware accessories let you use the handheld as a mobile presentation platform. Quickoffice also lets you create and view a PowerPoint file in native format. Documents to Go adds PDF support, lets you browse e-mail and view pictures on the Palm.

Quicksheet, part of the Quickoffice suite, is perhaps the best spreadsheet application available for the Palm platform

For those who only need word processing, Wordsmith is a powerful software that can read and write Microsoft Word and RTF documents.